9. It provides for a 19-member constitutional court. Its function is to decide the constitutionality of the Presidential decrees, Government orders and laws of the Federal Assembly.

10. It authorises the Russian legislature (Federal Assembly) to remove the President by way of impeachment, on the charge of high treason or grave crime. The resolution of impeachment should be approved by both the Houses by two-third majority.

CHINESE CONSTITUTION

After the Communist Revolution (New Democratic Revolution) led by the Communist Party of China (CPC) with Chairman Mao Zedong as its leader, the People's Republic of China was formed in 1949. Since then, China adopted four constitutions i.e., in 1954, 1975, 1978 and 1982.

The fourth and the present constitution of 1982 was drafted by the National Constitution Revision Committee set-up by the National People's Congress (NPC). The draft constitution, after it was approved by the Standing Committee of the NPC, was submitted to the people for nation wide discussions. Finally, the draft constitution was adopted by the NPC and promulgated for implementation by the announcement of the NPC on December 4, 1982. Its salient features are as follows:

1. Written Constitution The Chinese Constitution is a written constitution. It consisted (originally) of a Preamble and 138 Articles divided into four chapters. These are mentioned in Table 95.4.

2. Rigid Constitution The Chinese Constitution is rigid in nature. It contains a special procedure for its amendment. It can be amended by the NPC by a majority of two-thirds of its membership. But, the amendments to the constitution must be proposed either by the Standing Committee of the NPC or by one-fifth (or more) of the total deputies (members) of the NPC.

3. Socialist Constitution The Chinese Constitution is socialistic in nature and lays down the foundation of a socialist state. It declares that China is a socialist state governed by a people's democratic dictatorship that is led by the working class and based on an alliance of workers and peasants. It further declares that the socialist system is the fundamental system of China; leadership by the CPC is the defining feature of socialism with Chinese Characteristics; and it is prohibited for any organization or individual to damage the socialist system.

Table 95.4 Chinese Constitution at a Glance (as Amended till now).

Chapter Number	Chapter Heading	Articles covered
I	General Principles	1 to 32
II	Fundament Rights and Obligations of Citizens	33 to 56
III	State Institutions Section 1 – The National People's Congress	57 to 140